

Canadian Government





About the Course

Students learn about the electoral process, the different aspects of parliamentary government, the Canadian legal system, and the concept of citizenship. They will spend the final term learning about the structure of our local and provincial authorities.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Canadian Government: Grade 7 1 time/week 25 min	Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Canadian Government: Grade 7

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway? and Citizenship Notebook

→ INTRO

How would you answer the question that is in the title of the book you will begin reading today? Who is in charge in Canada? How does our country make decisions? How does a law get made? What happens during an election? In this course, you will learn about the electoral process, the different aspects of parliamentary government, the Canadian legal system, and the concept of citizenship.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-6 "All week our classmates" - "in a moment." (Audiobook chapters 1-2)

→ NOTEBOOK

The Citizenship Notebook is an excellent place to keep track of definitions and to copy diagrams. If any of these terms are new to you, you may choose to include definitions in your notebook: democracy, municipal, federal, parliament, legislature, legislative, executive, judicial. As you read through the book this year, look for other terms that are new to you. The diagram on page 6 would also be a good one to add to your notebook.

★ TEACHER TIP

If you are using the audio recording of the book, the readings will correspond with the audiobook chapters (with timestamps, if necessary), and the recordings clearly denote the corresponding page numbers. Students can be encouraged to take notes as they listen to the audio recording.

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Senators, the Supreme Court, and the Prime Minister

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?, Citizenship Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the three levels of government from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS OR NOTEBOOK

p.7-11 "When adults talk" - "by the government." (Audiobook chapter 3 0:00-8:49)

The following are points you can discuss with your parent or teacher, or write about in your citizenship notebook.

- Who are Senators, and what are the four important roles of the Senate?
- What is the role of the Supreme Court?
- What is the role of the Prime Minister? What kinds of appointments can he or she make?

→ VIEW

What do you think a Senator's day at Parliament Hill is like? Follow two of them around for a day to see what kind of work they do.

∞ Video Link: A Day in the Life of Senator Yonah Martin

∞ Video Link: A Day in the Life of Senator Dennis Glen Patterson

→ EXPLORE

Test your knowledge of who does what in the Senate.

∞ Link: Parliament at Work: Senate

• EXTRA HELPING

Have you ever wondered how and why Ottawa was chosen as Canada's capital city?

∞ Video Link: The Selection of Ottawa as the Capital of Canada



Term 1

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

More Government Positions and the British North America Act

Materials: Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the various positions in Parliament?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.12-17 "If Nathan were the prime minister"- "strong as written laws!"
(Audiobook: from chapter 3 at 8:50 to the end of chapter 4)

→ VIEW

1. Learn more about the role and duties of the Governor General.
∞ Video Link: What are the duties of Canada's governor general?
2. Learn more about the British North America Act.
∞ Video Link: The Words That Shaped Canada: The British North America Act